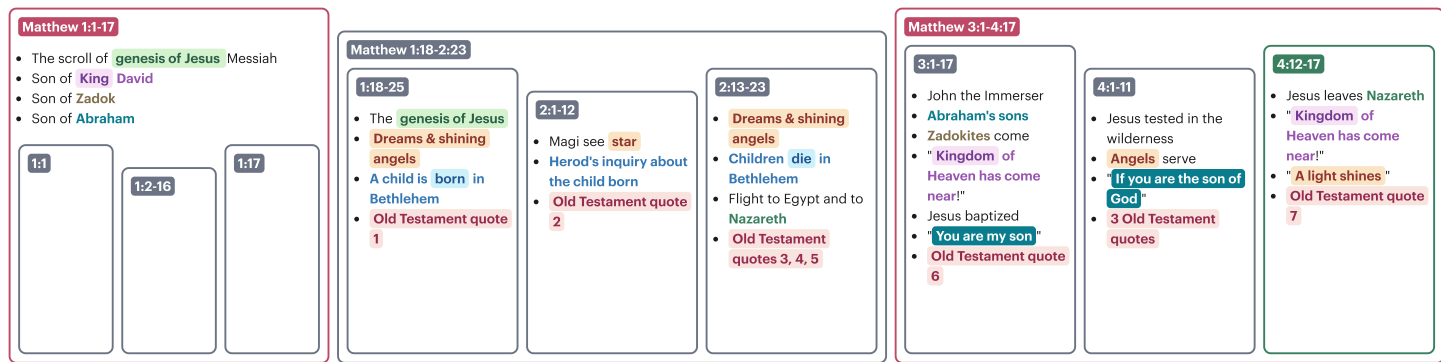


Session 5: A Messianic Genealogy

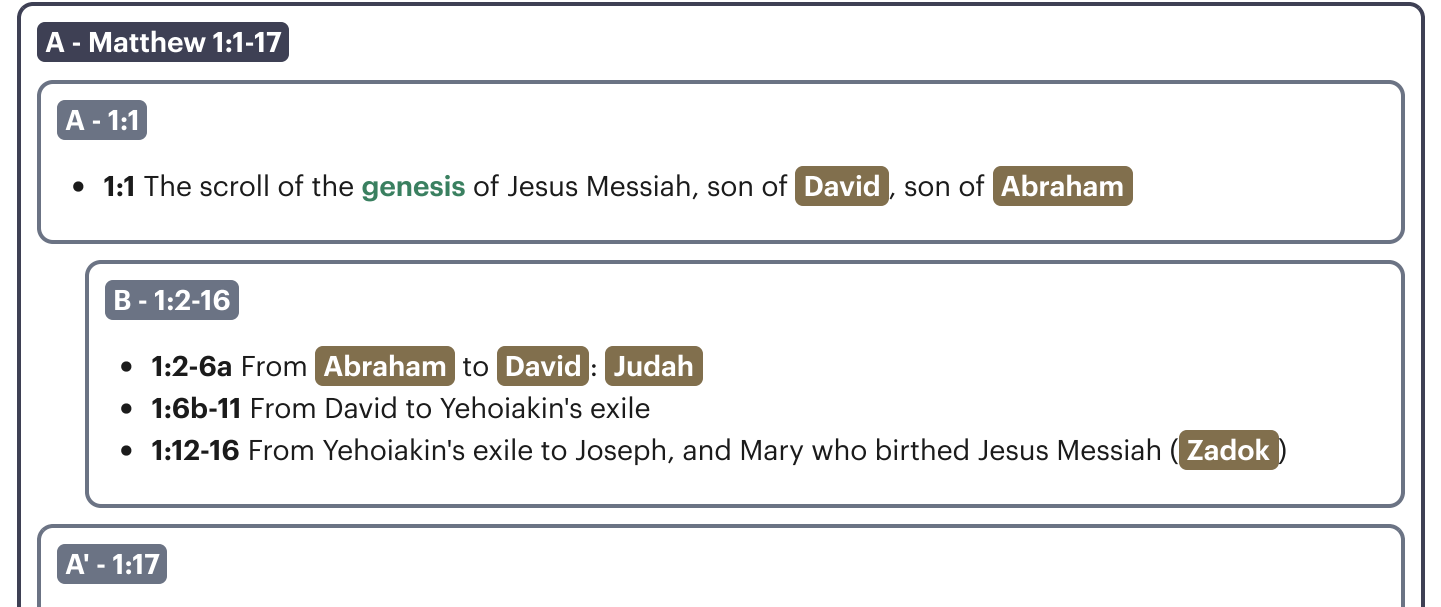
Key Takeaways

- Matthew shapes Jesus’ genealogy to focus on Jesus as the Son of David, Son of Abraham, and promised Messiah.
- Biblical authors employ numbers as vehicles of meaning. Matthew highlights numerical wordplays in this genealogy, inviting readers to contemplate deeper layers of meaning.
- The focus on “brothers” in the first two sections of the genealogy invites readers to look for the missing brothers in the third section.
- Matthew’s inclusion of five women in the genealogy links Jesus’ story to a pattern of God using surprising people and means to fulfill his promises.

Matthew 1:1-4:17 — Design and Message



Matthew 1:1-4:17. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).



- **1:17** 3 sets of 14 generations from **Abraham** to **David** to the exile to the Messiah

B - Matthew 1:18-2:23

A - 1:18-25

"The genesis of Jesus Messiah was like this ..."

- a - **1:18-23** Mary **pregnant** by Holy Spirit, **angel "appears" (phaino)** to Joseph, **"take Mary"**
- b - **1:22-23** **Old Testament quote 1 (Isa. 7:14)**
- a' - **1:24-25** Joseph obeys **angelic dream**, **takes Mary**, who **births a son**: Jesus

B - 2:1-12

- a - **2:1-3** Jesus was **born** in **Bethlehem**, magi see **star** in the east and come to **worship**, Herod hears
- b - **2:4-6** Herod's inquiry to Messiah's **birth** town: **Old Testament quote 2 (Mic. 5:4)**
- a' - **2:7-12** Herod & magi, trip to **Bethlehem**, **star** leads to child, **worship**, magi **dream** & depart

A' - 2:13-23

- a - **2:13-15** Joseph's **angelic dream**, "take child and Mary to Egypt" + **Old Testament quote 3 (Hos. 11:1)**
- b - **2:16-18** Herod **murders the sons** of Bethlehem + **Old Testament quote 4 (Jer. 31:17)**
- a' - **2:19-23** Joseph's **angelic dream**, "take child and Mary back to Israel" + **Old Testament quote 5 (Isa 11:1)**

A' - Matthew 3:1-4:17

A - 3:1-17

- a - **3:1-6** John the Baptizer, **Old Testament quote 6 (Isa. 40)**, Jerus. & **Judea** come, **"Repent, Kingdom of God has arrived!"**
- b - **3:7-12** **Zadokites** come, John's speech: Who are **Abraham's** children? Baptism of Spirit & fire
- a' - **3:13-17** Baptism of Jesus: voice from the skies, Spirit descends, "You are my **Son**"

B - 4:1-11

- **4:1** Jesus in the wilderness, tested by slanderer for 40 days
- **4:2-10** 3 tests of Jesus' loyalty, **3 Old Testament quotes (Deut. 8:6; 6:13; 16)**
- **4:11** Slanderer leaves Jesus, **angels** come and serve

- **4:12-17** Jesus goes to Nazareth, "repent, Kingdom of God has arrived" + Old Testament quote 7 (Isa. 9:1), light "shining"

Matthew 1:1-4:17. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

Matthew 1:1-17 — A Messianic Genealogy

1:1 The scroll of the birth-beginning (γενεσις) of Iesous Messiah, son of Daudid, son of Abra'am:

2 Abra'am¹ birthed (γεννω) Isaak,
 and Isaak² birthed Iakob,
 and Iakob³ birthed Iouda and his brothers,
 3 and Iouda⁴ birthed Phares and Zara from Tamar,
 and Phares⁵ birthed Esrom,
 and Esrom⁶ birthed Aram,
 4 and Aram⁷ birthed Aminadab,
 and Aminadab⁸ birthed Nasson,
 and Nasson⁹ birthed Salmon,
 5 and Salmon¹⁰ birthed Boes from Rakhob,
 and Boes¹¹ birthed Iobed from Ruth,
 and Iobed¹² birthed Iessai,
 6 and Iessai¹³ birthed Daudid¹⁴, the king,
 and Daudid¹⁴ birthed Solomon from the one of Ouriah,

7 and Solomon¹⁵ birthed Roboam,
 and Roboam¹⁶ birthed Abia,
 and Abia¹⁷ birthed Asaph,
 8 and Asaph¹⁸ birthed Iosaphat,
 and Iosaphat¹⁹ birthed Ioram,
 and Ioram²⁰ birthed Ozia,
 9 and Ozia²¹ birthed Iotham,
 and Iotham²² birthed Akhaz,
 and Akhaz²³ birthed Ezekia,
 10 and Ezekia²⁴ birthed Manasse,
 and Manasse²⁵ birthed Amos,
 and Amos²⁶ birthed Iosiah,

¹¹ and Iosia²⁷ **birthed** Iekhoniah²⁸ **and his brothers**,
until **the exile of Babylon**.

¹² After **the exile of Babylon**,
Iekhoniah²⁸ **birthed** Salathiel,
and Salathiel²⁹ **birthed** Zorobabel,
¹³ and Zorobabel³⁰ **birthed** Abioud,
and Abioud³¹ **birthed** Eliakim,
and Eliakim³² **birthed** Azor,
¹⁴ and Azor³³ **birthed** Sadok,
and Sadok³⁴ **birthed** Akhim,
and Akhim³⁵ **birthed** Elioud,
¹⁵ and Elioud³⁶ **birthed** Eleazar,
and Eleazar³⁷ **birthed** Matthan,
and Matthan³⁸ **birthed** Iakob,
¹⁶ and Iakob³⁹ **birthed** Ioseph⁴⁰, the husband of **Maria**,
from whom was **birthed** **Iesous**⁴¹,
who is called "Messiah."

¹⁷ All the **birth-generations (γενεα)** from **Abra'am** until **Dauid**: fourteen **birth-generations**,
and from Dauid until **the exile of Babylon**: fourteen **birth-generations**,
and from **the exile of Babylon** until **the Messiah**: fourteen **birth-generations**.

Matthew 1:1-17. Translation and Literary Design by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024)

The Genesis of Iesous

Matthew has introduced Jesus with a TaNaK-style genealogy (see [1 Chron. 1-9](#)), showing how his birth fulfills the long story of God's relationship with Israel. The three-part scheme (Abraham, David, exile to Babylon) shows how Matthew understands Israel's history as portrayed in the Hebrew Bible.

"The genealogy ensures continuity between Israel's story and the story that Matthew is about to narrate ... This genealogy prepares the reader to interpret Jesus as the heir of the promises to Abraham, the consummation of Israel's epic story that began in the patriarchal narratives of Genesis ... The strong emphasis given to Israel's exile imparts a particular shape to the history: the story of Israel is a story that juxtaposes God's covenant faithfulness—signified by the promise to Abraham and the promise to David of an everlasting kingdom—with Israel's unfaithfulness, as signified ... by the checkered history of the kings that led up to the deportation to Babylon ... The Messiah, in Matthew's narrative, is the one who saves his people from the consequences of their sins by closing the chapter of powerlessness and deprivation that began with the exile to Babylon ... Jesus is the one who will bring about the end of Israel's exile."

Hays, Richard B. (2017). [Echoes of Scripture in the Gospels](#). Baylor University Press. 110-111.

The opening line of the genealogy makes three implicit claims about the identity of Jesus: He is a new Adam, a new Abraham, and a new David.

The scroll of the birth-beginning (βιβλος γενεσεως) of Iesous Messiah	Genesis 5:1: “This is the scroll of the birthings (ספר תולדת) / βιβλος γενεσεως) of Adam ”
son of Dauid	2 Samuel 7: David , father of the messianic seed for Israel
son of Abra’am	Genesis 12:1-3, 22:18: Abraham , father of the seed for the blessing of the nations
<i>The Opening Genealogical Line.</i> Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).	

Jesus and Adam: By modeling the opening words of his genealogy after the genealogy of Adam in [Genesis 5:1](#), Matthew makes a key analogy between Jesus and Adam that functions as a foundation for the entire story. Jesus is the new human who will address the folly and failure of Adam and Eve and who will confront the snake who deceived them, reversing death. This all remains implicit, but we know that the apostles elsewhere saw a connection between Adam and Jesus (see [Rom. 5:12-21](#)).

Jesus and Abraham: By linking Jesus to the seed of Abraham, Matthew marks Jesus as the one through whom God’s blessing will spread to all nations (see [Gen. 12:1-3](#) and [Gen. 22:17-18](#)).

Jesus and David: By highlighting Jesus as the Son of David, Matthew makes an explicit claim that Jesus is the heir of God’s royal promises to David and his seed (see [2 Sam. 7](#) and [Ps. 72](#)), specifically that God’s Kingdom would spread to all nations through his line.

The Women in Jesus’ Genealogy

The fact that Matthew has given us a patriarchal (i.e., male) lineage of the royal line of David through Abraham and Judah highlights the presence of four women in the genealogy. And, additionally, the four women named are not the ones we would expect, like the matriarchs of Israel in Genesis: Sarah, Rebekah, Rachel, and Leah. The inclusion of these specific four women is part of a deliberate strategy because these four women are deeply connected within the narrative strategy of the Hebrew Bible.

- [Matthew 1:3](#): Tamar from [Genesis 38](#)
- [Matthew 1:5](#): Rahab from [Joshua 2](#)
- [Matthew 1:5](#): Ruth from [Ruth 1-4](#)
- [Matthew 1:6](#): Wife of Uriah (= Bathsheba) from [2 Samuel 11-12](#) and [1 Kings 1-2](#)

The following table shows how all four women’s stories have been designed with many important hyperlinks that set each on analogy with the others.

	Tamar Genesis 38	Rahab Joshua 2, 6	Ruth Ruth 1-4	Bathsheba 2 Sam 11-12 & 1 Kgs 1-2	The Canaanite Woman Matthew 15:21-28
A non-Israelite, on the “kick them out” lists in Deut. 7:1; 20:1	Gen. 38:6, 11 Judah’s wife is Canaanite; Tamar’s father lives nearby	Josh. 2:1 Rahab is a Canaanite prostitute who lives in Jericho	Ruth 1:4 Mahlon and Kilion “took for themselves Moabite wives”	2 Sam. 11:3 “Isn’t this Bathsheba, daughter of Eliam, wife of Uriah the Hittite?”	Matt. 15:21-22 “Jesus went into the region of Tyre and Sidon, and behold, a Canaanite woman from those regions came out ...”
Recently widowed	Gen. 38:8-10 Tamar becomes twice widowed		Ruth 1:5 Ruth becomes a widow	2 Sam. 11 Bathsheba becomes widowed because David murders her husband	
Unusual “liaison” with the promised lineage	Gen. 38:12-19 Tamar disguises as a prostitute to maintain the family “seed”	Josh. 2:1b-7 They “go into” Rahab the prostitute’s house at night	Ruth 3:2-14 Ruth secretly meets Boaz at night in the threshing floor	2 Sam. 11:1-4 David’s affair takes place at night, while he stays home during a war	
Bold assertion toward the line of David/Joshua	Gen. 38:25-26 Tamar proves Judah’s guilt with cord and seal	Josh. 2:12 “Now, swear to me by Yahweh, since I have done <i>khesed</i> to you, that you do <i>khesed</i> to my father’s house”	Ruth 3:9 “I am Ruth your servant. So spread your covering over your servant, for you are a kinsman-redeemer.”	1 Kgs. 1:15-21 Bathsheba requests that Solomon be made king instead of Adonijah	Matt. 15:25-27 Jesus’ silence prompts her to say “Lord! Help me!” She counters Jesus’ parable with a tweaked

Women Hyperlinks. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

	Tamar Genesis 38	Rahab Joshua 2, 6	Ruth Ruth 1-4	Bathsheba 2 Sam 11-12 & 1 Kgs 1-2	The Canaanite Woman Matthew 15:21-28
					parable in return
Red cord = Symbol of deliverance	Gen. 38:18, 25 "cord" belongs to Judah Gen. 38:28 "red" tied to firstborn	Josh. 2:18-19 a "red cord" is tied to the window "as a sign of faith " (אמת)			Matt. 15:28 "Great is your faith , O woman! Let it be as you desire."
Confession of faith in God of Israel OR Request for mercy/favor		Josh. 2:10-11 "Yahweh your God, he is God in heaven above and earth below"	Ruth 1:16 "Your people will be my people, and your God, my God"		Matt. 15:22b She cried out, "Lord, Son of David, have mercy on me!"
Sets precedent for Gentile inclusion		Josh. 9 The Gibeonites			Matt. 15:29-38 The feeding of the 4,000 Gentiles follows

Women Hyperlinks. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

"Jesus' identification in Matthew 1 as the 'Son of David,' is capable of many meanings, but the presence of these gentile women highlights the inclusiveness of the Messiah's role, to be a blessing to the nations as well as to save his own people from their sins ... Is the Davidic Messiah's role to be that of a new Joshua, who will again lead an obedient Israel to drive out the Canaanites? ... Or do the Canaanite women in Jesus' ancestry require a more positive relationship to gentiles? All this is at stake in Jesus' encounter with the Canaanite woman in Matthew 15:21-28. She may as well have stepped out of the genealogy, in order to press her own claims on the line of David as Tamar, Rahab, Ruth, and Bathsheba each did in their own way."

Bauckham, Richard (2002). "The Gentile Forerunners of the Messiah." [*Gospel Women: Studies of the Named Women in the Gospels*](#). Eerdmans. 44.

The Numerical Patterns in Matthew’s Genealogy

Matthew structures the genealogy into three sets of 14 generations, which creatively reshapes the traditional accounts of the lineage of David that we know from 1 Chronicles, which was certainly Matthew’s source.

In order to achieve the number 3 x 14, Matthew had to omit multiple generations from David’s genalogy.

Matthew 1:8-9	1 Chronicles 3:10-12
... Yehoshaphat Yoram - - - - - - - - - Uzziyahu Yotam ...	... Yehoshaphat Yoram Ahaziah Yoash Amaziah Azariah (= Uzziyahu) Yotam
Numerical Patterns in Matthew’s Genealogy—David. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).	

In the second list Matthew mentions “Ieknoniah and his brothers.” He omits three kings who ruled in short succession in the final generation of the exile before Ieknoniah.

Matthew 1:11	1 Chronicles 3:15-17
Iosia - - - - - - - - - Iekhonia	Josiah Jehoiakim Zedekiah Shallum (= Jehoahaz) Jeconiah
Numerical Patterns in Matthew’s Genealogy—Kings. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).	

Matthew also omits multiple generations in the third list, betwen Zerubbabel and Joseph and Mary. 1 Chronicles 3:19-24 provides a list of the six (or perhaps five) sons of Zerubbabel, but none of them match the names that Matthew lists here. The period in between Zerubbabel and Joseph is nearly 500 years, and Matthew has provides 13 names. The second list covers nearly 400 years, and Matthew provides 14 names, and we know he omitted many more. We assume that Matthew has also omitted names from this third list as well.

Numerical Symbolism (a.k.a. “Gematria”)

Biblical authors often used the numerical value of Hebrew and Greek letters to create more subtle layers of meaning that connect with the larger themes of the book. Steven Bryan has provided a thorough analysis of Matthew’s compositional technique and proposes that the names found at all four key junctures in the genealogy are numerically significant (information and chart adapted from Steven Bryan, “Onomastics and Numerical Composition in the Genealogy of Matthew,” *Bulletin for Biblical Research* vol. 30 [2020], 515-39).

Value of Name	Position in Genealogy
41	1st — Abraham
14	14th — David
40	28th — Jeconiah
	41st — Jesus
42	42nd — Messiah

Numerical Genealogy. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

1. Abraham: Jesus is placed in 41st position in the genealogy, precisely the numerical value of “Abraham” in Hebrew (אַבְרָהָם = 41).
2. David: The 3 x 14 shape of the genealogy is a numerical wordplay on the name “David” in Hebrew (דָּוִד = 14).
3. Christ: “Christos” / “Messiah” is placed as the 42nd name, precisely the numerical value of the Hebrew word “Messiah” (מָשִׁיחַ = 42).
4. Jeconiah, the last Davidic king before the exile to Babylon, has the numerical value of 40, precisely the number of names that leads up to Jesus, the 41st name (יְכִנְיָהוּ = 40).

For an Old Testament example of gematria in a genealogy, see the genealogy of the tribes of Jacob in [Genesis 46:8-27](#). 70 family members go with Jacob to Egypt; 14 children to Jacob through Rachel’s sons, 7 children through Bilhah’s line, Gad is the 7th in the list, who fathers 7 children; Gad = 7 in Hebrew (גָּד).

A Numerical Puzzle — 14 + 14 + 14 = 41??

One puzzle in Matthew’s genealogy is that he tells us in [1:17](#) that he has traced 3 x 14 generations from Abraham to the birth of the Messiah, and we know that he omitted multiple generations to come up with that number.

Why does he say “14 generations from the exile to the Messiah,” when he has only included 13 names?

Steven Bryan has offered a compelling solution (“The Missing Generation: The Completion of Matthew’s Genealogy,” in *Bulletin for Biblical Research* vol. 29, 294-316).

- Matthew has intentionally omitted many kings from the list.

- Matthew includes the unique phrase “and his brothers” two times in the genealogy.
 - “Judah and his brothers” (1:2)—Judah with his brothers make up the 12 brothers who go one to become the 12 tribes. This generation signals the constitution of the nation of Israel.
 - “Jechoniah and his brothers” (1:11)—Jechoniah and his brothers lived during the downfall of Judah and signalled the dissolution of the nation of Israel.

The fact that Matthew draws attention to the birth generation of Israel and then also to the exile-death generation of the nation means there can be little coincidence that Matthew leaves the third table of the genealogy unfinished, with one generation to go. Is it possible that the “Messiah and his brothers” will make up the 14th generation, completing the “David” number symbolism?

Matthew answers this question by leaving a trail of bread crumbs through the book. Notice how often Jesus describes his disciple community as a reconstituted Israel, picking up the royal heritage of their people.

Matthew 10:1-7 Instructor's Translation

¹ And summoning **his twelve apprentices** ...

² Now, the names of **the twelve apostles** are these:

first, Simon, the one called Petros

and Andreas **his brother**,

and Iakobos the one of Zebedaios,

and Ioannes **his brother** ...

⁵ These the twelve Jesus sent,

having instructed them, saying,

“Onto the road of the nations you will not depart,

and into a city of the Samaritans you will not enter,

⁶ but rather **go to the lost sheep of the house of Israel**,

⁷ and as you go, announce, saying,

"The kingdom of the skies has come near!"

Matthew 12:46-50 Instructor's Translation

⁴⁶ While he was still speaking to the crowds,

look, his mother and brothers had been standing outside,

seeking to speak with him,

⁴⁷ and someone said to him,

“Look, your mother and your brothers have been standing outside,

seeking to speak with you.”

⁴⁸ And responding he said to the one speaking to him,

“Who is my mother?

And who are my brothers?”

⁴⁹ And extending his hand to his apprentices, he said,

“Look, my mother and my brothers.

⁵⁰ For **whoever does the desire of my father in the skies,**

that one is my brother and sister and mother.”

Matthew 19:28 Instructor's Translation

And Iesous said to them,
“Amen, I say to y’all,
that y’all who follow me,
in the re-birthing,
when the son of the human sits upon the throne of his honor,
**y’all too will sit upon twelve thrones,
judging the twelve tribes of Israel;**

Matthew 28:9-10 Instructor's Translation

⁹ And look, Iesous met them, saying,
“Good day!”
And approaching, they grabbed his feet and bowed down to him.
¹⁰ Then Iesous said to them,
“Don’t be afraid.
Go announce to my brothers
that they should depart unto Galilaias,
and there they will see me.”

The Genealogies of Matthew and Luke

The Enoch Dimension and the Number 7 in Luke’s Genealogy

- There are 77 generations (11 sets of 7) between Adam and Jesus in Luke 3:23-38, which is a number of “ultimate fulfillment” (remember Lemek’s 77 in Gen. 4:24 and Jesus’ ironic allusion to this story and number in Matt. 18:22).
- Enoch is in the 7th position (as he is in Gen. 5:21).
- The only ancestor of Jesus (= Yeshua) to share his name is in the 49th position, and Jesus himself is in the 77th position.
- Abraham culminates the third set of 7 generations, and David culminates the fifth set of 7 generations.
- There are 49 (= 7 x 7) generations between Adam and Jesus (Ιησους, Matt. 3:29), the only ancestor to share Jesus of Nazareth’s name. The number 49 echoes the ten Jubilee cycles from Daniel 9 (7 x 70).

Luke has designed the genealogy so that the first four rounds of seven generations conclude with a key patriarch.

1st Seven	Enoch
2nd Seven	Shelah
Enoch Dimension. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).	

3rd Seven	Abraham
4th Seven	Admin
5th Seven	David
6th Seven	Joseph
7th Seven	Jesus (= Yehoshua)
8th Seven	Shealtiel
9th Seven	Mattathias
10 Seven	Joseph
11th Seven = 77th generation = Jesus of Nazareth	
<i>Enoch Dimension. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).</i>	

“Luke’s genealogy embodies a claim about Jesus’ identity. It gives Jesus the place of ultimate significance in world history. It includes and highlights his descent from David by the non-royal line as the prophesied messianic son. However, he is more than just a a new David. David has his own special place as the fifth 'seventh,' as does Abraham as the third 'seventh,' but Jesus’ position at the end of the eleventh seven, in the seventy-seventh generation surpasses that of every predecessor from Adam onwards. He is greater than Enoch and greater than Abraham and David. He is the consummation of human history.”

Bauckham, Richard (2015). “The Lukan Genealogy of Jesus,” in [Jude and the Relatives of Jesus in the Early Church](#). Bloomsbury Academic. 365.

Luke and Matthew Compared

Luke’s Genealogy	Matthew’s Genealogy
Adam to Abraham	----
Abraham to David	Abraham to David
<i>Comparing Luke and Matthew. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).</i>	

Luke's Genealogy	Matthew's Genealogy
David Nathan Mattatha Menna Melea Eliakim Yonam Yoseph Yudah Simeon Levi Matthat Yorim Eliezer Yeshua Er Elmadam Cosam Addi Melchi Neri Shealtiel Zerubbabel	David Solomon Rehoboam Abiyah Asa Yehoshaphat Yoram [Ahaziah, omitted, see 1 Chron. 3:11] [Yoash, omitted, see 1 Chron. 3:11] [Amaziyah, omitted, see 1 Chron 3:12] Uzziyah Yotham Akhaz Khizkiyah Manasshe Amon Yoshiah Yekonyah Shealtiel Zerubbabel
Rhesa Yoanan Yoda Yosekh Semein Mattathias Maath Naggai Hesli Nahum Amos Mattathias Ioseph Yannai Melchi Levi Matthat Eli	Abioud Eliakim Azor Sadok Achim Elioud Eleazar Matthan Iakob Yoseph Yeshua!!
<i>Comparing Luke and Matthew.</i> Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).	

Luke's Genealogy

Yoseph
Yeshua!!

Matthew's Genealogy

Comparing Luke and Matthew. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

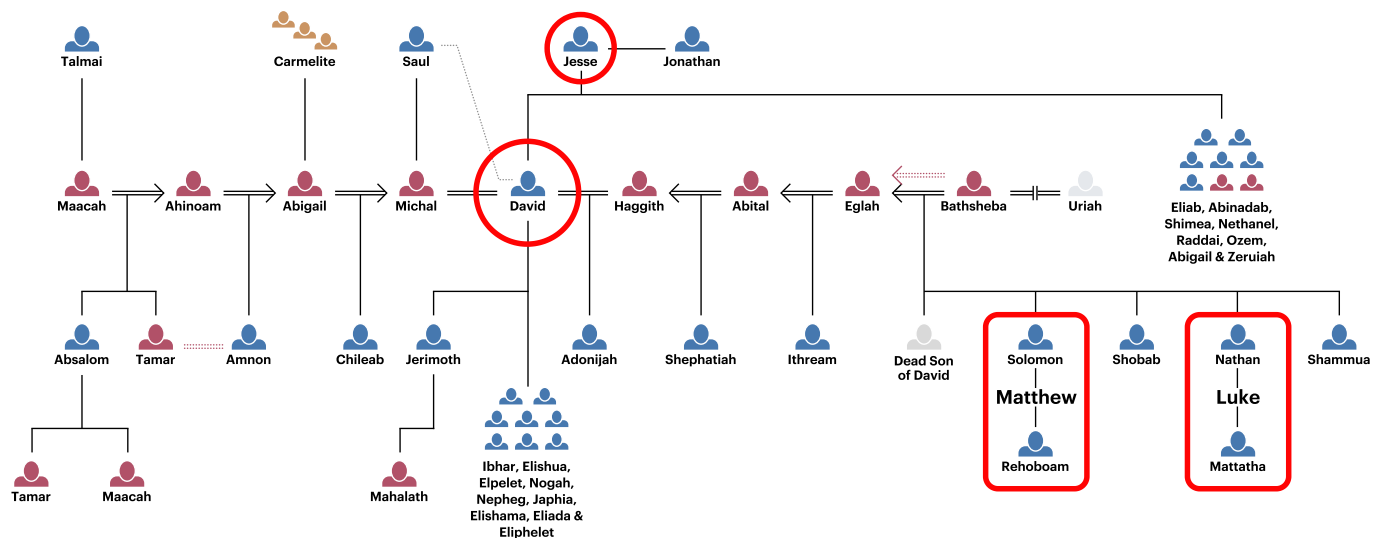
Luke's genealogy is the same as Matthew's from Abraham up to David, but they part ways after David.

- Matthew follows the royal and enthroned family in Jerusalem that came from Solomon.
- Luke follows the lesser known Nathan, the ninth son of David, whose story remains untold in the Hebrew Bible.

Luke's lineage and Matthew's lineage join back together in Shealtiel and Zerubbabel, the last known descendants of David to have any governing authority in Israel ([Matt 1:13](#) / [Luke 1:27](#)).

But after these two, Matthew and Luke's lines depart again, only converging once more in Joseph, the adopted father of Jesus.

Visual Display of David's Genealogy from Jesse to David's Sons



Visual Display of David's Genealogy. Created by Tim Mackie for BibleProject Classroom: Rise of the Messiah (2024).

"It seems that Luke wants the descent from David to evoke not the high status of royal descent, but the low status of David's humble origins. This is confirmed by the genealogy Luke gives to Jesus, which traces Jesus' descent through Joseph from David and back to Adam. This is a sophisticated theological text, embodying, as biblical genealogies do, much more than just biological information. According to this genealogy, Jesus was descended from David not through Solomon and the kings of Judah as in Matthew's

genealogy, but through David's little-known ninth son Nathan. While making contact with the official line of heirs to the Davidic throne in Zerubbabel and his father Shealtiel, the genealogy otherwise consists of entirely unknown names between Nathan and Joseph. This embodies an interpretation of the prophecies of the Davidic messiah, according to which the Messiah is to come not from the line of David's royal successors but from David's own family origins in Bethlehem (see Isaiah 11:1-5 and Micah 5:1-2) ... The new king is not to be born in the royal palace in Jerusalem, but in insignificant Bethlehem, where David's own story began ... among the ordinary people. Bethlehem is the city of David, but not of any of David's sons through Solomon."

Bauckham, Richard (2002). "The Gentile Forerunners of the Messiah." [*Gospel Women: Studies of the Named Women in the Gospels*](#). Eerdmans. 73-74.

Reflection Question

What major features of Matthew's genealogy did you notice? How do these features communicate meaning as an introduction to Matthew's Gospel?